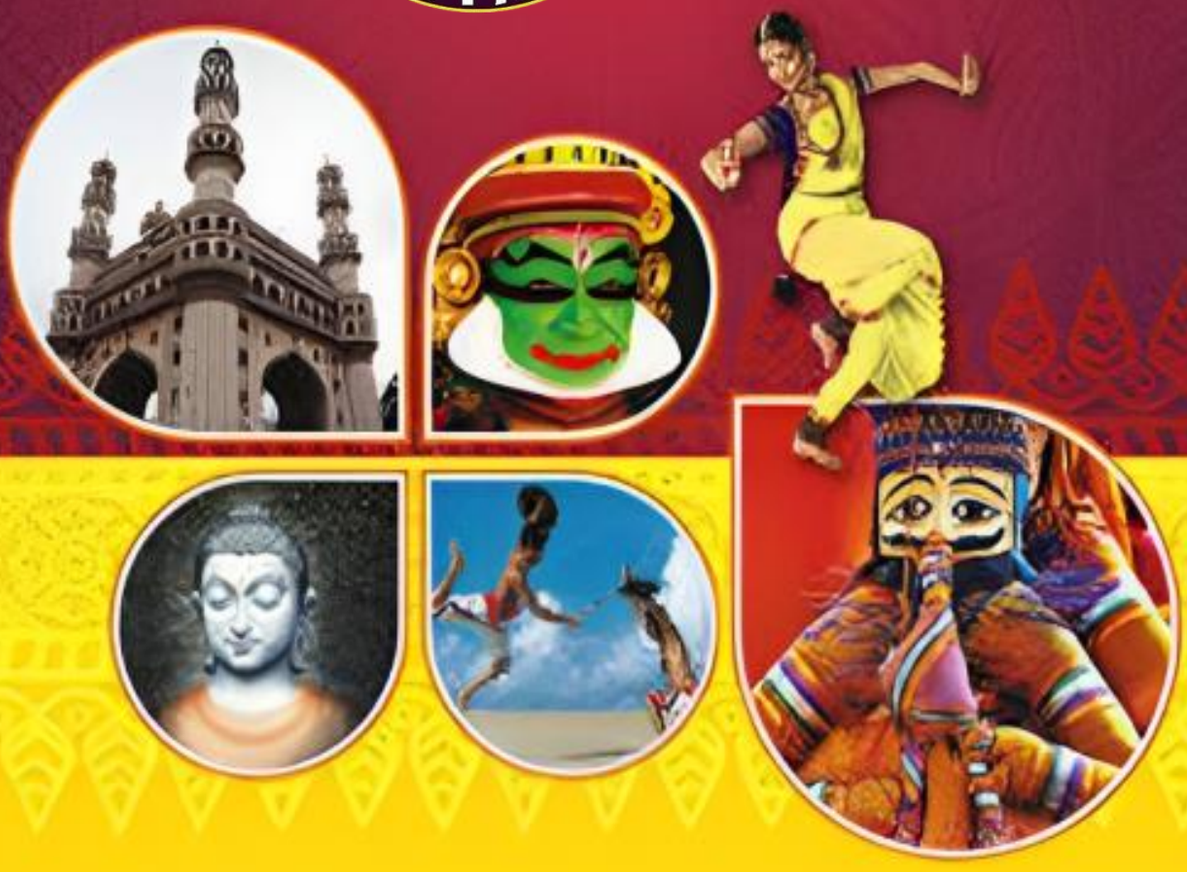
CULTURE AND COMMUNICATION

DU KI PADHAI

(VAC)



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CULTURE AND COMMUNICATION

VALUE ADDITION COURSE (VAC)

COURSE CREDITS – 2

SYLLABUS

UNIT- 1

ETHICAL VALUES FROM INDIAN CULTURAL HERITAGE

- Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam
- United We Stand, Divided We Fall
- Ek Bharat, Shresht Bharat

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OVERVIEW

India is a land of diverse cultures, traditions, and philosophies that have evolved over thousands of years. At the heart of this rich tapestry lies a set of timeless ethical values deeply embedded in Indian cultural heritage. These values have not only endured the test of time but continue to resonate with relevance in our contemporary society. In this chapter, we embark on a journey to explore the profound ethical values rooted in the essence of Indian culture, offering insights into how they have shaped our perceptions of ethics, unity, and interconnectedness.

VASUDHAIVA KUTUMBAKAM

- Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam is a Sanskrit phrase that means **"The world is one family".** It is an ancient Indian concept that promotes the idea of equality and brotherhood among all human beings.
- The phrase Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam is made up of three Sanskrit words, Vasudhaa (earth/world), iva (like) and kutumbakam (large/extended family).

- The verse finds mention in Maha Upanishad (VI.-72)
- It is a concept that teaches us the importance of peace, harmony, empathy, compassion, cooperation and recognizing the interconnectedness of all living beings.
- Vasudhaiv a Kutumbakam encourages us to expand our circle of concern beyond our immediate surroundings and embrace a global perspective.
- It reminds us that, regardless of our differences in nationality, religion, or race, we share a common humanity and a responsibility to care for one another and our planet.

Contemporary Relevance

The idea of the phrase remains relevant today as it emphasizes a global perspective, prioritizing the collective well-being over individual or family interests.

It encourages to think about the welfare of others, fostering global solidarity and responsibility, especially in addressing crucial issues like climate change, sustainable development, peace, and tolerance of differences.

This verse of Maha Upanishad is engraved in the entrance hall of the Parliament Of India.

The theme and the logo for India's G20 Presidency from December 1, 2022, till November 30, 2023 has a mention of "Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam" or "One Earth-One Family-One Future".

Here are some practical applications of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam:

Embracing Diversity: Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam reminds us that we all come from different cultures, religions, and backgrounds. By accepting this difference, we can create a more inclusive and tolerant society.

Promoting Unity And Cooperation: Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam reminds us that we all live on the same planet. By recognizing this unity, we can work together to meet common challenges.

Promoting Social Justice And Equality: Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam reminds us that we are all equal. By recognizing this equality, we can create a more just and equitable world.

Promoting World Peace And Harmony: Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam reminds us that we are all part of the same family. By embracing this concept, we can help to reduce hatred and violence and promote peace and harmony.

UNITED WE STAND, DIVIDED WE FALL

The phrase "United we stand, divided we fall" is a proverb that emphasizes the importance of unity and cooperation. It is a reminder that when we work together, we can achieve great things, but when we are divided, we are weaker and more vulnerable.

- This proverb is deeply rooted in Indian cultural heritage. The concept of unity is central to many Indian religions and philosophies.
- For example, the Hindu scripture Bhagavad Gita teaches that we are all interconnected and that we should work together for the common good. The Buddhist concept of Sangha, or community, also emphasizes the importance of unity and cooperation.

- Indian independence movement was successful because people from all walks of life came together to fight for a common cause.
- India's diversity is one of its greatest strengths, but it is also a potential source of division. That is why it is important for Indians to remember the proverb "United we stand, divided we fall."

Here are some specific examples of how we can apply the proverb "United we stand, divided we fall" in our daily lives:

- Be respectful of others, regardless of their background or beliefs.
- Be willing to listen to different perspectives and to learn from others.
- Work together to solve problems and to achieve common goals.
- Stand up for what is right, even if it is unpopular.
- Be a bridge-builder between different groups of people.

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EK BHARAT SHRESHTHA BHARAT

Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat is a government initiative launched in 2015 to promote unity and understanding between the people of India's diverse states and union territories.

The initiative ‘Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat’ was announced by Hon'ble Prime Minister on 31st October, 2015 on the occasion of the 140th birth anniversary of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel.

The initiative is based on the principle that India's strength lies in its diversity, and that by working together, with the knowledge of the culture, traditions and practices of different states & UTs we can build a better future for all.

The broad objectives of the ‘Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat’ initiative are as follows:

CELEBRATE the Unity in Diversity of our Nation and to maintain and strengthen the fabric of traditionally existing emotional bonds between the people of our Country.

PROMOTE the spirit of national integration through a deep and structured engagement between all Indian States and Union Territories through a year-long planned engagement between States.

SHOWCASE the rich heritage and culture, customs and traditions of either State for enabling people to understand and appreciate the diversity that is India, thus fostering a sense of common identity

ESTABLISH

long-term engagements.

CREATE an environment which promotes learning between States by sharing best practices and experiences.

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